

ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNERS

PROGRAM INFORMATION AND COURSE OF STUDY



**Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District
6638 Mill Road**

Brecksville, Ohio 44141

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PROGRAM INFORMATION
AND
COURSE OF STUDY**

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Brecksville-Broadview Heights City Schools

ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNER

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

This document represents the collaboration of the following individuals who have created a handbook for the English Language Learner Program. The teachers are committed and dedicated to improving the education of students who are learning English as a second or additional language. The writers are to be commended for their desire and commitment to promote language acquisition.

The thanks of the Board of Education, administration, colleagues, parents and students go to each of the contributors identified below:

Dr. David Martin	Director of Curriculum & Instruction
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Mission Statement

**The mission of the
Brecksville-Broadview Heights City
School District is to inspire and
prepare students to be lifelong
learners, to be flexible in
approaching opportunities for
growth, and to be effective as well as
ethical contributors to our global
society.**

BRECKSVILLE-BROADVIEW HEIGHTS CITY SCHOOL DISTRICT

THE VISION

The Brecksville Broadview Heights City School District strives to be a premier public school district for all who learn, teach, discover and work here.

We challenge ourselves to create and maintain engaging curriculum and academic excellence. We foster ongoing, life-long learning commensurate with each student's individual potential and future aspirations.

We will:

- Encourage the transition from dependence to independence in a secure, stimulating and diverse learning environment.
- Educate and foster the development of the whole student in the pursuit of effective leadership and responsible values, attitudes and personal growth.
- Maintain shared responsibility among all members of the school community for the improvement of educational programs and responsible fiscal and facilities planning for future student needs.

We are committed to empowering all students to make and create opportunities for achievement in a dynamic, ever changing world while acknowledging that all learn at different levels, rates and styles. We seek to meet the academic needs of all students and to promote the value and creativity of the educational process.

2018
Educational Advisory Team

BRECKSVILLE-BROADVIEW HEIGHTS CITY SCHOOL DISTRICT

Curricular/Instructional Philosophy

The curriculum and instruction of the Brecksville Broadview Heights City School District will provide an educational program to help each student realize his/her potential as a contributing member of a global society. Both the curriculum and the instructional process reflect that each student is a unique individual and learner.

The curriculum is designed to educate all students. It provides opportunities for students to develop knowledge and skills, to communicate with others, to meet daily needs and to become lifelong learners and problem solvers. The instructional process is based on the belief that every individual has the potential to learn and succeed.

We recognize individual learning styles and provide for differences through a wide variety of instructional experiences and activities in all areas. Curriculum and instruction provide for the development of personal growth, independence, civic responsibilities and career aspirations.

2018
Educational Advisory Team

I. ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNER PROGRAM INTRODUCTION

PREAMBLE

Language minority students have the same rights, privileges, and responsibilities as other students in the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District. The purpose of the English Language Learner Program is to help them overcome their linguistic, cultural and academic difficulties and assure that they receive an equal educational opportunity. This will be achieved through active and regular collaboration between the mainstream classroom and the English Language Learner teachers.

HISTORY

We believe that just as everyone learned a first language, everyone can learn a second language. This language can be acquired in informal situations and learned in formal classroom settings.

We believe that the first priority of the English Language Learner Program is to foster basic communication skills in English, which in turn will lead to self-confident expression in this society, the ability to cope in everyday life situations, involvement in mainstream curriculum and extracurricular activities, and an understanding, both theoretical and practical, of American democracy.

We believe that the English Language Learner Program should help students appreciate the value of their primary cultural identity and provide multicultural experiences for all students.

We believe that parental involvement and staff development are integral components of an effective ELL Program.

The ELL Program is essentially transitional. Its goal is attained when a student is able to exit the program and participate successfully in the mainstream classroom.

Historically, the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District has enrolled ELL students from diverse cultural and socioeconomic backgrounds. Over 25 languages are represented. As this population continues to grow, the ELL Program continues to evolve.

II. LEGAL RESPONSIBILITIES

There exists a substantial body of federal law which establishes the rights of Limited English Proficient students which define the legal responsibilities of school districts serving these students. Administrators and school boards who are responsible for local policies and programs can turn for guidance and direction to this body of law. It includes the following:

1868 Constitution of the United States, Fourteenth Amendment

“...No State shall...deny to any person within its jurisdiction the equal protection of the laws.”

1964 Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964

“No person in the United States shall, on the ground of race, color, or national origin...be denied the benefits of, or be subject to discrimination under any program or activity receiving the federal financial assistance.

Two U.S. Supreme Court rulings, one interpreting the Fourteenth Amendment and one interpreting the Civil Rights Act of 1964, have exercised considerable influence over the education rights of language minority students. These cases may be summarized as follows:

1974 Lau vs. Nichols

The U.S. Supreme Court ruled that a school districts failure to provide English language instruction to LEP students denied them meaningful opportunity to participate in the district’s educational program in violation of Title IV of the Civil Rights Act of 1964; the Court further noted that equality of opportunity is not simply providing LEP students the same facilities, textbooks, teachers, and curriculum which non-LEP students receive.

1982 Plyler vs. Doe

The U.S. Supreme Court ruled that the Fourteenth Amendment to the U.S. Constitution prohibits states from denying a free public education to undocumented immigrant children regardless of their immigrant status. The court emphatically declared that school systems are not agents for enforcing immigration law, and determined that the burden undocumented aliens may place on an educational system is not an accepted argument for excluding or denying educational service to any student.

No Child Left Behind 2001

Public Law 107-110 115 STAT. 1690 Jan. 8, 2002 – Section 3102

This is an act passed by President George W. Bush in 2001, reauthorizing the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965 (ESEA). Under the NCLB Act, federal law requires improvement in the performance of America's schools while ensuring that no child will be left behind amidst failing schools or programs. These improvements include curriculums based upon challenging state standards in reading and math, annual testing for students, and statewide annual progress objectives ensuring that all groups of students reach proficiency within 12 years (AYP). Student groups include those sorted by poverty levels, race, ethnicity, disability, and limited English proficiency.

NCLB is based upon four principles:

- Accountability for results
- Increased parental choice and input
- Greater local control and flexibility
- Best practices based on scientific research

**Information obtained through the US Department of Education*

III. General ELL Terminology

ASSESSMENTS

OELPS, OELPA, Ohio Achievement Tests, State Air Tests, Stanford and Otis Lennon (optional), State Diagnostics (i.e., KRA-L), LAS, IPT

BICS

Basic Instructional Communication Skills refers to a student's social English language skills. Research indicates that students take 1-3 years to acquire functional social language skills. (Cummins, 1981)

CALPS

Cognitive Academic Language Proficiency refers to the English language skills necessary to function successfully in an academic/school environment. Research indicates that it takes students from 3-7 or more years to acquire such academic language skills. (Cummins, 1981).

ELL

English Language Learner; also referred to as LEP, ESL

ELL FILE

This file is kept by the English Language Learner teacher. Contents of the file include test scores, family and registration information, work samples, and progress reports. This file travels with the student.

ELL PROGRAM

ELL is defined as a structured language acquisition program designed to instruct students in the English language (speaking, reading, writing, and listening) and to assist students with core academic content.

ELL STUDENT/SHELTERED ENGLISH

An ELL student is one whose native language is other than English, and who has difficulty speaking, reading, writing, or understanding the English language to the point where it impedes learning. This would include but not limited to:

1. Individuals who were not born in the United States or whose native language is a language other than English.
2. Individuals who come from environments where a language other than standard English is dominant.
3. Individuals who are American Indian and Alaskan Native students and who come from environments where a language other than English has had a significant impact on their level of English language proficiency, and by reason thereof, have sufficient difficulty speaking reading, writing, or understanding their English language to deny

such individuals the opportunity to learn successfully in classrooms where the language of instruction is English.

(20 U.S.C. 3223 – Title VII of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965)

ELL TEAM

The Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District endorses the team approach as the most effective way to deliver services and provide support for students. The following staff may be part of the team working with students:

- Classroom Teacher
- Counselor
- Speech and Language Teacher
- Intervention Specialist
- Title I Teacher/Reading Teacher
- School Psychologist
- ELL Teacher
- Principal/Administrator

When concerns arise regarding a student's progress, curriculum, and placement, the team defined above will address these issues at an Response to Intervention (RtI) in the building. Any staff member may request a team meeting through RtI.

ESL CLASS

This is a year long elective offered to high school students for which they receive credit.

HOME LANGUAGE SURVEY

This is a required document completed by all parents registering a student new to the district to determine if English is spoken in the home.

IEP

This is an Individualized Education Plan prepared for students who require additional intervention services.

INCLUSION

English Language Learner students are placed in regular education and receive additional support from an ELL teacher within the regular education classroom.

IPT

IDEA Proficiency Test (used in grades Pre-K - 3)

LANGUAGE SERVICE PLAN

The Service Plan is a required written document that outlines required goals and accommodations for each ELL student that address the Ohio standards.

LAS

Language Assessment Scales Test (includes Pre-LAS for Pre-K – first grade).

LEP

Limited English Proficient is the federal term for a student receiving service in English (reading, writing, listening, speaking), as well as support in all content areas.

LEP PULLOUT

Students spend part of the day in a regular classroom, but are pulled out for a portion of the day to receive intensive small group or individual instruction.

OELPS

(Ohio English Language Proficiency Screener) A statewide mandated screening assessment for students new to the district. Participation in this assessment is required if a language other than English is answered on the Home Language Survey. The results of this survey determine a student's qualification into the ELL Program.

OELPA

(Ohio English Language Proficiency Assessment) A yearly statewide English language proficiency assessment for those students participating in the ELL program. This computer-based test assesses students in each of the four language domains. (reading, writing, speaking and listening) Their performance on this test results in demonstrating the English language proficiency growth of each student for one academic school year and determines if the student qualifies to remain in the ELL program for the following school year or if they exit the program permanently.

TRANSLATORS/INTERPRETERS

These are individuals who provide support services. The term translator is typically associated with converting written text between languages and the term interpreter is typically associated a person with converting oral language.

IV. ELL PROGRAM GOALS

The English Language Learner program of the Brecksville-Broadview Heights City School District is designed to establish equal educational opportunities and promote academic excellence for language students. It accomplishes its goals by helping these students achieve competence in English and mastery of all content area matter skills necessary to meet grade promotion and graduation standards. This program uses various strategies to develop the student's ability to effectively listen, speak, read and write in English and is intended to provide the student's access to the district's basic curriculum. It does so by providing instruction in English to meet the following four goals:

A. To use English to communicate in social settings

A primary goal of ELL instruction is to assist students in communicating effectively in English, both in and out of school. Such communication is vital if English Language Learners are to avoid the negative social and economic consequences of low proficiency in English and are to become informed participants in our democracy. English Language Learners also need to see that there are personal rewards to be gained from communicating effectively in English. This goal does not suggest, however, that students should lose their native language proficiency.

B. To use English to achieve academically in all content areas

In school settings, English competence is critical for success and expectations for ELL learners are high. They are expected to learn academic content through the English language and to compete academically with native English-speaking peers. This process requires that learners use spoken and written English in their schoolwork.

C. To use English in socially and culturally appropriate ways

ELL students in U.S. schools come into contact with peers and adults who are different from them, linguistically and culturally. The diversity in U.S. schools mirrors the diversity in this country and around the world that young people will encounter as they move into the 21st century world of work. In order to work and live amid diversity, students need to be able to understand and appreciate people who are different and communicate effectively with them. Such communication includes the ability to interact in multiple social settings.

D. To communicate effectively with parents

In order to meet its goal of promoting academic excellence for English Language Learners, the ELL program must facilitate communication with the parents of these students. Therefore, the ELL teacher will establish and maintain communication with the home through phone calls and

written messages, and – as much as possible – he or she will provide interpreting and translating services for important school notices and information. Additionally, the ELL teacher will encourage parent participation in school activities and in parent information and training sessions (for example, Meet the Teacher Night, Open House). The ELL teacher will conduct parent meetings for the purposes of the ELL program. Finally, the ELL teacher will cooperate with community agencies to ensure that families receive appropriate and adequate health and social services.

These goals will be accomplished in alignment with the Ohio English Language Proficiency Standards

V. ENGLISH LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY STANDARDS FOR ELL STUDENTS

Listening Standards in English for ELL Students

1. ELL students will develop the English listening skills required both for academic achievement and for communication in socially and culturally appropriate ways.

- 1.1 Comprehend spoken instructions
- 1.2 Identify main ideas and supporting details of spoken English
- 1.3 Determine speaker attitude and point of view
- 1.4 Comprehend the meaning of academic and/or specialized vocabulary when spoken
- 1.5 Make inferences and predictions when listening to speakers

Speaking Standards in English for ELL Students

2. ELL students will develop the English speaking skills required both for academic achievement and for communication in socially and culturally appropriate ways.

- 2.1 Speak fluently, using clear pronunciation and with appropriate intonation and stress
- 2.2 Speak using appropriate grammar and vocabulary
- 2.3 Speak for varied purposes, both formal and informal, with focus, relevance and cohesion

Reading Standards in English for ELL Students

3. ELL students will develop the English reading skills required both for academic achievement and for communication in socially and culturally

appropriate ways.

- 3.1 Demonstrate reading strategies
- 3.2 Identify the meaning of written vocabulary
- 3.3 Read with comprehension
- 3.4 Read for varied purposes

Writing Standards in English for ELL Students

4. ELL students will develop the English writing skills required both for academic achievement and for communication in socially and culturally appropriate ways.

- 4.1 Write using appropriate conventions and grammar
- 4.2 Write for varied purposes and audiences, with appropriate tone and voice, using various media
- 4.3 Write using the writing process
- 4.4 Write using a range of vocabulary, sentence structures and verb tenses

VI. PROCEDURES

A. IDENTIFICATION OF STUDENTS

In compliance with the U.S. Department of Education and the Office for Civil Rights, all students new to the district are enrolled and registered with the Board of Education. At that time, a Home Language Survey is completed by the parent or guardian and filed in the student's cumulative folder. A copy will be forwarded to the ELL teacher if a student is identified as speaking a primary or home language other than English. Additionally, a student may be identified through classroom teacher referral. The ELL teacher will arrange for a prompt assessment of the student to determine eligibility for ELL services.

B. ENTRANCE ASSESSMENTS

Based on the Home Language Survey or teacher referral, initial assessment must begin within 10 days of a student's first day of school. Assessments will examine a student's English language skills in reading, writing, speaking, listening, and comprehension.

All levels K-12 will use the OELPS (Ohio English Language Proficiency Screener) as well as informal assessments are used to determine a student's English language level.

C. ELIGIBILITY FOR ELL SERVICES

Students are eligible for services if they receive a Proficiency Status score less than Proficient (Proficiency Not Demonstrated, Emerging, Progressing) on the OELPS screener. A notification letter will be sent out to notify family whether or not a student qualifies for services at this time.

Explanation of Levels

Beginning indicates that the student who is limited English proficient is:

- Beginning to understand short utterances
- Beginning to use gestures and simple words to communicate
- Beginning to understand simple printed material
- Beginning to develop communicative writing skills

Early Intermediate indicates that the student who is limited English proficient can:

1. Understand simple statements, directions, and questions
2. Use appropriate strategies to initiate and respond to simple conversation
3. Understand the general message of basic reading passages
4. Compose short informative passages on familiar topics

Intermediate indicates that the student who is limited English proficient can:

1. Understand standard speech delivered in school and social settings
2. Communicate orally with some hesitation
3. Understand descriptive material within familiar contexts and some complex narratives
4. Write simple texts and short reports

Early Advanced indicates that the student who is limited English proficient can:

1. Identify the main ideas and relevant details of discussions or presentations on a wide range of topics
2. Actively engage in most communicative situations familiar or unfamiliar
3. Understand the context of most text in academic areas with support
4. Write multi-paragraph essays, journal entries, personal/business letters, and creative texts in an organized fashion with some errors

Proficient-Trial Mainstream indicates that the student who is limited English proficient can:

1. Understand and identify the main ideas and relevant details of extended discussion or presentations on familiar and unfamiliar topics
2. Produce fluent and accurate language
3. Use reading strategies the same as their native English-speaking peers to derive meaning from a wide range of both social and academic texts
4. Write fluently using language structures, technical vocabulary, and appropriate writing conventions with some circumlocutions

**BRECKSVILLE-BROADVIEW HEIGHTS CITY SCHOOLS
ELL IDENTIFICATION FLOWCHART**

NEW REGISTRANT

EXISTING STUDENT

HOME LANGUAGE SURVEY

- Completed by parent
- Kept in permanent file
- Copy forwarded to ELL teacher by BOE

Referral form filled out by classroom teacher, given to ELL teacher.

SCREENING ASSESSMENT (OELPS)

- Given by ELL teacher
- Results sent to the office of Curriculum & Instruction with referral form filled out by ELL teacher
- C & I sends parent a notification of testing letter

**DOES NOT
QUALIFY/NO
SERVICES
PROVIDED**

(C&I sends out
“Does Not Qualify”
letter)

QUALIFIES

Students scoring less than Proficient.

PARENT CONTACT/PERMISSION

- Form completed by office of Curriculum & Instruction
- Signed parent copy returned to the office of Curriculum & Instruction (Copy forwarded to ELL teacher for cum file.)

NO

**NO SERVICES
PROVIDED**

Student must still
take the OELPA until
exit criteria is met
unless parent declines
testing

YES

STUDENT PLACEMENT IN PROGRAM

- Service plan prepared by ELL teacher and shared with classroom teachers, principal, and counselor.
- Results and identification added to district ELL Service Roster.

ACCOMMODATIONS

Adaptations

- Adapt the way the instruction gives instruction (i.e. in written form vs. orally)
- Adapt the output that is required of the student (seatwork, homework, quizzes, tests, and projects)
- Instructional goals are the same as for all the other students in the class (same grade level indicators for all students – for each area).
- Graded the same way as regular education students.

MODIFICATIONS

- Change the instructional goal/objective for a particular student (which is different from the rest of the class). This would be a change in grade level expectations from the course of study.
- Modify grading to reflect student's progress towards his goals – rather than progress toward curricular performance objectives.
- Since you have modified your content, you can provide an adjusted grade.

ADJUSTED GRADES Adaptations vs. Modifications	
Adaptations that DO NOT require an adjusted grade	Modifications that DO require an adjusted grade
Read a content area test aloud to the student if he/she has weak reading skills, processing or attention problems.	Read aloud a reading comprehension test
Shortened practice assignments that don't lessen the content	Easier/alternative practice assignments that are a change in grade level expectations from the course of study
Enlarged print	
Fewer questions per page (not altering the goal or instructional objective)	Student is required to answer only part of the question
Oral response accepted instead of a written response (in the case of a writing disability or ELL)	Teacher probes in order to get an acceptable oral response
Accept answers that are not in a complete sentence on content area tests (assuming all information is present and makes sense as a phrase, list, chart, etc.	Accepting answers that are not in a complete sentence on a language arts assessment that evaluates writing skills
Different assignment covering the same content (assuming the student will be accountable for the same content on a test or assessment) – e.g. Illustrate and write spelling words instead of writing in a sentence.	Alternate different content (different spelling words, vocabulary words, concepts, skills).
Highlighting, repeating, clarifying directions	Extensive explanation of a question or probing in order to get an acceptable answer
Provides copies of notes and/or class notes instead of having student copy outlines or notes.	Allow student to use notes or worksheets to help them with a test.
	Allow student to correct or retake a test or indicating that an answer is wrong and that the student should try again.
Provide a general study guide in advance of a test	Specific test questions are provided to the student in advance of the test
Extended time given	Time constraints changed on timed tests (i.e. multiplication test)
Small group testing if a student has reading or attention problems	Small group testing in order to implement some of the above modifications.
Preferential seating	

* This table is not all inclusive.

It is strongly recommended that the student's adjusted grading program be reflected throughout the quarter on quizzes, tests and assignments so that report card grades are consistent with the cumulative quarter grades.

D. PARENTAL NOTIFICATION OF PROGRAM ELIGIBILITY

Parents are notified of placement in the program by the Office of Curriculum and Instruction.

E. PLACEMENT IN ELL PROGRAM

After signed parental permission is received, students will be placed in the ELL Program.

- Students should be placed in classroom settings that provide the best possible opportunities for them to continue to learn content material while they are learning English. ELL students are entitled to participate in district programs in a non-discriminatory manner.
- Most students should be placed in age-appropriate classrooms. Even if students have not attended school before, the social nature of schooling cannot be ignored. It is important to place students with their peers and allow them to interact naturally. Exceptions may include students who have not attended school for more than a year.
- Intervention Specialists/aides may work directly with students in the classroom in conjunction with the classroom teacher. In this way, Intervention Specialist/aides have a better understanding of what, why, and how content material is being studied and can provide support that is directly connected to classroom goals.
- Consideration will be given to modifications of assessment for ELL students. Classroom teachers and ELL teachers will recognize that every test is a language test; students may understand content but be unable to decipher a multiple-choice test. Finally, the ELL teacher will assist teachers in inventing ways of allowing students to show or demonstrate what they have learned without using complex English.
- Consideration will be given to the scheduling of the pullout services so that it is least disruptive to the students' academic classes. Every effort will be made to coordinate classroom intervention services and ELL instruction.

F. ELL SERVICE PLAN

An individualized service plan is created each academic school year. The plan identifies current language levels, states language goals based on ELL standards, and outlines appropriate accommodations and modifications. Consideration will be given to modified assessments and listed on the service

plan if applicable. Accommodations and modified assessments can reflect student's efforts in the classroom.

Other possible measures included but are not limited to are:

- writing samples
- oral reading samples grades
- standardized achievement tests
- common grade-level assessments
- teacher observations
- OELPA (Ohio English Language Proficiency Assessment)

See appendix for modifications versus alternative assessments and grades.

G. ENTERING TRIAL MAINSTREAM

An ELL student will enter the trial mainstream phase of the program when it is the student has achieved scores of 4 and 5 with one 3 in the reading, writing, speaking and the listening domains of the English language to participate. Such proficiency will be demonstrated through OELPA test scores and achievement tests.

Once students progress to the mainstream/trial period, they continue to be serviced in the domain necessary until they reach full proficiency as demonstrated on the OELPA.

H. MONITORING PROCEDURES FOR EXITED STUDENTS

Monitoring of exited students will be the responsibility of the classroom teachers in coordination with the ELL teacher and counselor. The student may receive monitoring based on teacher referral and parental consent.

Examples of Monitoring include:

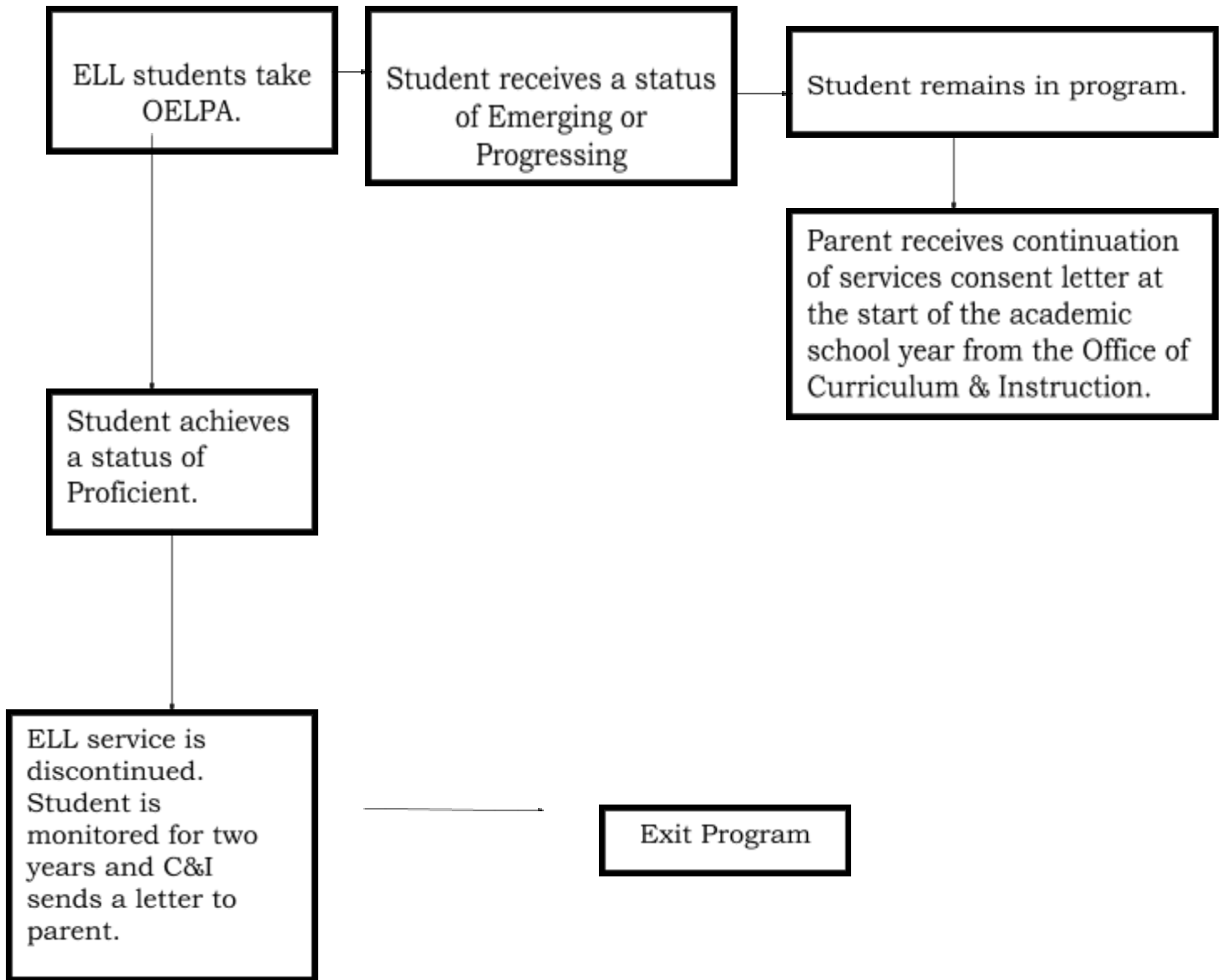
1. writing samples
2. oral reading samples
3. grades
4. standardized/achievement test scores
5. teacher observation
6. teacher/parent/student referral

When indicators suggest that an ELL student is having difficulties attaining academic and social expectations which are unrelated to the student's ELL status, the student will be referred to the school RtI team for intervention

strategies. In the event the various strategies are not successful, the student may be referred for further evaluation.

The Brecksville-Broadview Heights City Schools has an established procedure for referring students for special education evaluations. These special intervention strategies must be utilized to ensure that such students are not referred for formal Special Education evaluations when the lack of academic progress is primarily related to language background or a need for more ELL and/or support services. The student may require an evaluation administered in his/her native language.

**BRECKSVILLE-BROADVIEW HEIGHTS CITY SCHOOLS
ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNER PROGRAM
EXIT CRITERIA FLOWCHART**



CRITERIA FOR EXITING LEP PROGRAM

In order to be exited from LEP programs in Ohio, students need to demonstrate the ability to understand, speak, read, and write the English language at a level in which they are able to:

- a) achieve successfully in classrooms where the language of instruction is in English;
- b) meaningfully participate in academic assessments in English;
- c) participate fully in society in the United States.

The following criteria will be used to indicate that a student has attained the required level of English proficiency to be exited from a district's LEP program:

1. The student has attained a composite score at the proficient level on Ohio's approved English language Proficiency Assessment (OELPA).
2. The student has subsequently successfully completed at least two years of the monitoring period in classrooms where English is the language of instruction.